



The latest S-Class advances the art of luxury not through excess, but by making every journey feel quieter, calmer and more considered.



Hamburg's urban reinvention isn't built on levelling the derelict, industrial relics of its maritime past, or deporting its dockside history to sterile museum corridors and glossy coffee table books. Instead, the city has chosen to romance the past, weaving its gritty history with a new era of opulent design. While the look and feel still fans centuries-old charm, the historical texture has been gracefully transformed into expressions of modern and futuristic architecture. The warehouses and jetties now wear a different purpose; where waterfronts once bustled with the chaos of sailors and stevedores, longshoremen and labourers, urban chic rewrites the passage of time, punctuated by office complexes, residential buildings, elegant waterfront cafes and walking paths that criss cross a record number of bridges, all set to outnumber those in Venice.

The futuristic glass building of the Elphi Concert Hall sits next to the world's largest complex of contiguous warehouses (a UNESCO World Heritage site), making a clear case for why so many cities consider Hamburg a model for redevelopment of an old port city. After all, true luxury isn't about erasing history, but embodying it.

Much like the city, the car I am driving from Hamburg also embodies its past; although transformed, not so much from the outside but from the inside out. While the car has 2,500 new parts and the engineers at Mercedes-Benz claim that the car is over 50 per cent new, the structure and the body shell is the same as before albeit with some impressive cosmetic and functional upgrades